

would be a slot that'll allow users to place a smartphone. When worn, users would be able to view VR content on the smartphone screen.

Google Cardboard, which is an open source platform is where most would get to have their first VR experience. It has created its own VR sub-industry with many manufacturers using the basic layout of the cardboard and building more advance versions, which generally don't use cardboard as material. Anyone can easily get their hands on the basic schematics, get them printed on materials, cut and glue them together along with the right pair of lenses to create their own headset. Everything you need to make one is available in a free PDF that can be downloaded from the Google Cardboard page.

Google didn't stop after creating Cardboard, they made a bigger splash into the VR scene with Daydream. Unlike Cardboard, which was built on mobile systems, Daydream was actually imbedded inside Android, starting from version 7.1 Nougat. This made Daydream a more powerful platform. But the extent of control it allowed developers, made it unavailable openly. Along with the Daydream View headset, Google also released a wireless controller. The sensors on-board the controllers were able to provide information about the location of controller and approximate the position of the user's hand. Many major Android phone manufacturers such as Samsung, HTC, LG and Huawei have announced that they'll be making Daydream ready phones. It's interesting to note the interest of HTC in the VR industry, with their own headset already in the market, they plan to create devices which are capable of running mobile VR content as well.

Like HTC, even Samsung is placing huge bets on the VR industry, especially the mobile sector. Apart from manufacturing Daydream ready hardware, they also have their own mobile VR headset in the market, Gear VR. Samsung has already spent loads of money in marketing its headset, before even Google announced Daydream. Another thing interesting about Gear VR is the fact that it was made in a partnership with Oculus. The experience of Oculus did reflect on Gear VR, at least in the early days of mobile VR.

Mobile VR is far more affordable than higher-ups. The most expensive of them, Gear VR costs \$99, Daydream View drops the price a little to \$79. Cardboard takes the bottom most spectrum of the expense leaderboard. Anyone willing to pay for printing, cutting, joining and the lenses, can have their own headset which works out to barely ₹200.

But the price of Cardboard really keeps it at the end of quality spectrum as well. It is essentially a lump of cardboard or plastic resting on your nose.